

Hit Gameplan

Sagarika Ghatge, the gutsy girl of *Chak De India* has struck another goal. The actor has been signed by Percept Picture Company (PPC) for its film, *Raftaar*. "This is a fast-paced thriller with Emraan Hashmi in the lead. We paired Ghatge opposite him because she is a fresh face and a good actor," says Pooja Kashyap, associate vice-president, feature films, PPC. We are wondering whether she will brave the onslaught of the serial-kissing Hashmi? Watch this space.



MAKING BONDS

'The World' was not enough for Bond girl **Denise Richards**. Now, she has arrived on the Indian horizon to set the Hindi screen on fire. The former supermodel who made her Hollywood debut with *Wild Things*, plays a cameo in Sajid Nadiadwala's film, *Kambakkht Ishq*. Richards, who is seen in a beach-side wedding scene with Akshay Kumar, says that she is "thoroughly enjoying being a part of Bollywood".

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Talent Reunited

They have made their mark in Hindi and Marathi films and have replaced each other on television shows. But now, **Renuka Shahane** has roped in Pallavi Joshi to play the lead in her new film *Rita*. Based on Shanta Gokhale's novel *Rita Velinkar*, the movie is being directed by Shahane. "I needed someone who can play a character from the age of 17 to 40, an actor who looks young, fresh and mature," says Shahane. After sharing screen space on the music show *Antakshari*, the two are set to work together again.



ANINDITO MUKHERJEE



DIVINE ROLE

It's been a long-awaited move and **Smriti Irani** is finally set to make her Hindi film debut. Giving the commercial productions a miss and staying clear of her familiar 'Jai Shri Krishna!' the small screen's Tulsi has opted for a devotional film where she personifies a mosque. Called *Mallik Ek*, the film is based on the life and teachings of Sai Baba. "Smriti is the narrator of the film. She's excellent in her diction and a personality people look up to," says producer Kishori Shahane.



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